

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

PART A Group Interaction

This article appeared in an online blog:

Brisbane's waterfront shows Hong Kong the way

Few places in the world have a more stunning natural asset than Victoria Harbour, yet there has been little effort to turn it over to public enjoyment.

My recent trip to the north Australian city of Brisbane made that obvious. There are no spectacular skyline views or night-time light shows reflected on shimmering waters. Yet the city's council has turned their waterfront into a place of recreation and enjoyment for people to enjoy simple activities. There are 20km of floating walkways and bicycle paths, riverside restaurants, parks, gardens and even a beach.

A free ferry service makes for leisurely travel between the business and shopping district, restaurants and attractions. Among the places I visited was the Greek Garden, a 1,500-square-metre area of land on the river's south bank where herbs and vegetables are grown, largely by volunteers; it is essentially a kitchen garden aimed at showing how to grow food plants sustainably at home. The fresh produce is harvested and given away free from food carts. As well as the Greek Garden, an art gallery and performing arts complex, there's a man-made beach, grasslands, rainforest, a pagoda, a giant wheel, plazas, walkways, a promenade, shops and restaurants.

The area, as with other riverside stretches, is lively and flourishing. Hong Kong's harbour front is, by comparison, dull and boring. Tsim Sha Tsui's Avenue of the Stars and the laser light show each evening are interesting, but the unfriendly environment of concrete paving and benches doesn't encourage people to stay.

You have been asked to propose facilities that could improve Victoria Harbour. The facilities should encourage more local people to visit the harbour. You may want to talk about:

- what people might enjoy doing at Victoria Harbour front
- which facilities might be suitable for Victoria Harbour front
- how the new facilities could best be promoted
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you often go to Victoria Harbour?
2. What do you enjoy most on a visit to Victoria Harbour?
3. What would attract young people to visit Victoria Harbour?
4. Should the government do more to improve Victoria Harbour?
5. Should the harbour be for business or for pleasure?
6. What types of facilities at the harbour are attractive for families with children?
7. Should the government make Victoria Harbour more accessible to the public?
8. Would you say that Victoria Harbour is the symbol of Hong Kong?